

sellsell marketplace updates - 18042026

UPDATE: 18/04/2026:04:30PM

SHAZ EJ



Where we are

You have already moved well past the idea stage. The project now has a real working base across local, GitHub, and server workflows.

1. Core product direction is clear

You're building an **AI-powered conversational marketplace**, not just a normal listing site.

The reference marketplace flow you reviewed is:

- marketplace listing grid
- listing detail page
- protected reply/contact action
- login/signup gate
- inquiry/message initiation

Your system should support that same baseline flow, but with AI layered on top.

2. Branch situation is mostly understood

You audited the branches and found:

- **origin/server** is the strongest production base
- it already includes most major backend modules
- **search** exists mainly in the **kuwait** branch family
- the correct strategy is to keep **server as base** and selectively bring search into it

So the architecture decision is now much clearer.



3. Auth and verification work has progressed

You already worked on:

- login
- signup
- email verification with Brevo
- legacy-user login handling
- verified/unverified user logic

You also confirmed the desired user flow for /chat:

- user comes to /chat
- login or signup
- verify by email
- then access chat

That target flow is now defined.

4. Local Docker environment is running, but not fully clean

You successfully rebuilt locally and got containers up.

From logs, you identified two important local issues:

Fixed / mostly addressed

- Prisma schema was synced with:
 - notification_jobs now pushed into DB schema

- JWT_SECRET missing in environment
- runtime env validation in middleware causes 500 if missing
- Prisma generate inside running container gives permission issue, but that is not the main blocker

So local infrastructure is close, but environment cleanup is still needed.

5. You compared your system with a traditional marketplace

That comparison clarified that your system should not stop at:

- listings
- detail page
- message modal

It should continue into:

- AI search
- AI-assisted inquiry
- conversation flow
- seller response flow
- chat-led transaction support

That was an important product clarification.

6. OTP login direction is now defined

You want to implement **OTP-based login** in Sell-Sell using the **same pattern as your DOTECH project**.

You already identified the source reference:



- local path: /Users/shazej/Documents/dotech/dotech_2026

So OTP is now a real next feature, not just an idea.

What is already completed

These are the things that are effectively done or mostly done:

- project direction defined
 - branch audit completed
 - strongest base branch identified
 - merge strategy decided
 - local and server workflow understood
 - marketplace flow understood
 - listing detail + auth gate + inquiry flow concept mapped
 - email verification approach implemented in code
 - Brevo integration direction decided
 - legacy unverified user login workaround discussed
 - local Docker build now completes
 - Prisma schema push was executed locally
-

What is still left to complete

This is the real remaining work.

A. Fix local runtime fully

Your local build is not the same as a clean local app runtime yet.

Still needed:

- add/fix JWT_SECRET in .env



- confirm app no longer throws middleware env errors
- confirm homepage loads without 500
- confirm worker no longer throws schema/runtime issues
- confirm local /chat flow works end to end

This is immediate and important.

B. Finish

/chat

authentication flow

You said you want to ensure sell-sell.com/chat works for:

- login
- signup
- email verification
- then access

That still needs to be fully tested end to end.

Still needed:

- new user signup from chat flow
- verification email delivery
- verification link success
- verified login success
- unverified login blocked correctly
- direct access to /chat redirects or handles auth correctly

This is one of the highest-priority functional tests.

C. Complete server deployment with latest auth changes



You've made multiple auth-related changes locally and through branches, but the important thing is making sure the final clean version is actually on the server and rebuilt correctly.

Still needed:

- ensure latest origin/server includes final intended auth behavior
- pull latest on server
- rebuild on server
- verify server env contains:
 - JWT_SECRET
 - APP_BASE_URL
 - BREVO_API_KEY
 - BREVO_FROM_EMAIL
 - BREVO_FROM_NAME
- verify live email verification works

D. Merge search from

kuwait

into

server

This is a major backend task still pending.

You already discovered:

- server = strongest production branch
- kuwait = has search module

Still needed:

- diff origin/server vs origin/kuwait
- identify only search-related files
- selectively integrate search into a temp branch



- test locally
- merge into server
- deploy safely

This is probably the most important structural backend task left.

E. Decide and implement OTP login

OTP login is not implemented yet in Sell-Sell. It is still a planned feature.

Still needed:

- inspect DOTECH OTP implementation
- map DOTECH auth flow vs Sell-Sell auth flow
- decide whether OTP is:
 - email OTP
 - phone OTP
 - both
- integrate into Sell-Sell without breaking existing login
- update backend + frontend
- test OTP flow end to end

This is a major feature still pending.

F. Clean up authentication UX

You already saw a few UX-level issues earlier such as:

- generic internal errors
- [object Object]
- invalid JSON from HTML response pages

Still needed:



- ensure all auth routes return JSON consistently
- improve frontend error display
- prevent HTML error pages from breaking client parsing
- make verification and login messages clear

This is partly fixed conceptually, but should be validated in code and UI.

G. Complete seller-side / inbox-side workflow

So far, you've mostly mapped the buyer-side flow:

- browse listing
- open listing
- auth
- send message

What still needs to be confirmed or built clearly is:

- where seller receives inquiry
- seller inbox / dashboard
- seller reply flow
- how conversation continues
- notification flow for seller

This is essential if the marketplace is truly conversation-led.

H. Full backend validation against product flow

You asked what should exist in backend, and you audited branches. That gave a good picture, but the actual running product still needs full validation.

Still needed:



- verify inquiries are saved correctly
 - verify notifications are sent correctly
 - verify favorites / reviews / reports work
 - verify orders/deals modules are actually usable, not just present
 - verify admin/moderation paths work in real flow
-

I. Local testing checklist is not complete yet

You still need a clean full local QA pass.

That means testing:

- homepage
 - listing grid
 - listing detail
 - login
 - signup
 - email verification
 - /chat
 - inquiry flow
 - seller receive flow
 - search
 - protected routes
 - logout/session persistence
-

Priority order I'd recommend

Immediate

1. fix local env and remove 500
2. confirm local app loads cleanly
3. verify /chat auth + email verification flow end to end

Next

4. deploy latest stable auth flow to server



5. verify live email verification works on server

Then

6. merge search from kuwait into server
7. test locally
8. deploy

After that

9. implement OTP login using DOTECH pattern
 10. complete seller inbox/reply workflow
-

Short version

You already have:

- strong backend base
- clear product direction
- working branch strategy
- email verification path
- local Docker setup mostly running

You still need to finish:

- local runtime cleanup
- /chat login/signup/verify flow testing
- server deployment validation
- search merge from kuwait
- OTP login implementation
- full seller-side messaging workflow
- final end-to-end QA